Report writing checklist

This checklist should be used before the submission of all written reports by students in the Bachelor of Science in Computing in Digital Forensics and Cyber Security.

1. **Have you familiarised yourself with the rules relating to the use of AI for the assessment?**
   - These will normally be outlined in the assessment brief using a colour/traffic light system that outlines to what extent AI may be used, if at all.
   - If you do not have this information or you are unsure **you should ask your lecturer**.

2. **Has the lecturer supplied you with a report template?**
   - If so you must comply with the guidelines in the template.

3. **Did you use the spell checker to correct spelling mistakes and grammatical errors?**

4. **Does your document have a cover page and any required signed declaration/coversheet?**
   - The cover page typically contains the school name, module name, assignment/report name, date and the name(s) and student number(s) of the author.
   - Normally typing/printing your name into the declaration page is accepted as a signature.

5. **Does your document have a table of contents (and table of figures if needed)?**

6. **Is your document divided into appropriate sections with clearly marked headings?**
   - The title of each section should reflect the content of that section.
   - If a section is particularly long consider dividing it into a number of individual sections.

7. **Does your report or essay contain all the information required for the assignment or project?**
   - This may include diagrams, formulae, results and computations in addition to the information contained in the text.
   - You should read through the assignment or lab sheet to verify if you have sufficiently covered the required material.

8. **Does your document contain any run-on or rambling sentences?**
   - Each sentence should contain only one key point or idea.
   - If the end of any sentence contains information relating to some new idea, rewrite it as a new sentence.

9. **Check if all ideas in a single paragraph are logically related.**
   - Each paragraph should develop a single topic that should be introduced in the first sentence of the paragraph.
   - The following sentences in the paragraph should provide further information to support the topic introduced in the first sentence.

10. **You should not refer to "I", "we" "you" etc. in a technical or scientific report.**
    - For example, "I recorded the measurements from the experiment and we verified Ohm's Law." can be rewritten as "The measurements from the experiment were recorded and found to verify Ohm's Law".

11. **Identify sentences that have redundant words.**
    - Reports usually read better if redundant words are removed.
    - If a sentence still makes sense after a word or phrase is removed, you should consider removing it from that sentence.
    - If you write as you speak it is very likely that you will introduce redundant words and phrases into your reports. This usually causes confusion for the reader.

12. **Plagiarism. All work that you present must be your own work.**
    - If you ever have any doubts regarding plagiarism you should consult a lecturer for clarification.

13. **References. You should reference all sources of information used to write a report. This may include diagrams, pictures etc.**
    - Use the referencing style recommended by the lecturer (IEEE, Harvard etc.).

<u>If you are unsure about any of these points you should seek help from the lecturer that has set the assignment.</u>